PURDUE UNIVERSITY
Davidson School of Chemical Engineering
ChE 30000: Professional Development Seminar Series

Spring 2026
Wednesday, 3:30 - 4:20 pm EST, PHYS 203

Syllabus

In this class, everyone is expected to uphold *Purdue's Honor Pledge*: "***As a boilermaker pursuing academic excellence, I pledge to be honest and true in all that I do. Accountable together - we are Purdue.***"

1. Objective

This course is a continuation of CHE 20000. The overall goal of this course is to introduce students to career options for chemical engineers and to provide tools and tips for succeeding in their job search. Lectures on the additional topics of ethics and safety will be given. A series of 12 lectures is planned, in addition to the first and last sessions, which are considered business meetings.

On completing this course, the students shall be able to:

- Identify the wide range of career opportunities offered by the Bachelor of Science in Chemical Engineering degree
- Demonstrate an understanding of the need for developing leadership skills, professional integrity and ethical decision making in the professional practice of chemical engineering (20000→); (→40000, 42000, 45000)
- Demonstrate an understanding of contemporary issues encountered in the professional practice of chemical engineering including business practices, environmental, health, and safety issues and other public interests (20000→); (→40000, 42000, 45000)
- Demonstrate an appreciation of the need for engaging in life-long learning and using appropriate learning strategies to maintain and enhance the professional practice of chemical engineering (20000→); (→40000)

This course addresses the following Chemical Engineering Program outcomes:

3) Communicate effectively with a range of audiences.
4) Recognize ethical and professional responsibilities in chemical engineering situations and make informed judgments, which must consider the impact of engineering solutions in global, economic, environmental, and societal contexts.
7) Acquire and apply new knowledge as needed, using appropriate learning strategies.

2. Instructors

Dr. Gabriela Nagy, Phone: 765-496-1710, email: nagyg@purdue.edu
Office hours: Please request an appointment via email, at nagyg@purdue.edu.

3. Specific Course Information. Procedures and Policies

ChE 30000 is a one credit hour, required course for chemical engineering students. The course is offered during both the fall and the spring semesters. Please note there is no textbook for this course.

3.1. Course resources and iClicker Cloud

An American Institute of Chemical Engineering (AIChE) membership is required for this course. AIChE membership is needed to complete assignments for this course through the AIChE Academy. You can learn more about the AIChE Academy here: https://www.aiche.org/academy.

AIChE Membership is FREE for students and upon graduation, the Davidson School of Chemical Engineering will extend your free membership for two additional years. If you are not an AIChE member yet, visit https://www.aiche.org/ to join, or to renew your membership. Our school has a very prestigious AIChE Student Chapter led by **President, Rebecca Bedwell** (rbedwel@purdue.edu). Should you have any questions about membership, please reach out to Rebecca and the Purdue AIChE Student Chapter Leadership Team.

iClicker Cloud is used to engage the class in different ways and to record attendance. Attendance/participation is worth 15% of your final grade (5 points/seminar class). Use **https://join.iclicker.com/GHDU** to join iClicker Cloud for this class (**code is GHDU**) and participate in activities/attendance quizzes. Each student is required to bring to class a mobile device, such as a smart phone, tablet, laptop with access to internet to be used to complete polls or other in-class activities in iClicker. You MUST create an iClicker student account following the steps below, unless you already have an account:

To set up your iClicker account:

1. Go to https://student.iclicker.com/. You will use the bottom portion of the login page to sign in in with your campus account.
2. Select "Purdue University West Lafayette" from the list and click the Go button.
3. Log in to the campus site using your Purdue login and password. You will be redirected back to iClicker to finish setup.

You will always log in for class from here using your Purdue login.

You can also download the iClicker student app and login at the start of the class.

The instructor will also go over the logistics of setting up your student iClicker account correctly during the first class and everyone will have the opportunity to try using this platform in class and confirm that it works correctly. **iClicker will use geolocation to record answers for polls**; this means that if you are not physically in class when you try to join with iClicker, you will not be able to participate in attendance polls and will not be counted as present. Therefore, you will need to allow the device you are using to reveal your location to successfully check in. If you have any issues with your device's location settings, refer to the Attendance Geolocation Troubleshooting Guide. The use of the iClicker student app is preferred for better accuracy with the geolocation. If you have problems participating in polls during class, please see the instructor at the end of class.

3.2. Course Communications

Brightspace: All course materials, announcements, assignments, etc. will be posted on Brightspace site for this course. Each student is responsible for confirming that they can access Brightspace.

E-mail: E-mail will be used for announcements and reminders from the instructor to only those students enrolled in the course. Please make sure that these emails are not being caught by any spam filtering software. If you do not receive these emails, please verify that you are enrolled in the course with your ChE academic advisor.

3.3. Attendance/Participation

All students are **expected** to attend the seminar sessions, arrive before the class starts and stay until explicitly dismissed by the instructor. Attendance will be taken during class, at random times, via ***iClicker*** polls, and geolocation is used to record student responses. You will need to allow the iClicker app to reveal your location to successfully check in. Although you can also use the web browser to check into your iClicker account and complete polls, the use of the app is recommended due to better accuracy with geolocation.

Participation in all iClicker polls is required to be counted present in class. If you cannot complete the polls with iClicker for any reason during class, please talk to the instructors after class, or you will be counted absent.

Please email Dr. Gabriela Nagy (nagyg@purdue.edu) if you are unable to attend class **for a valid reason** such as: interview, illness, family emergency or a reasonable excuse (e.g.: "I forgot when class was" and "I had a test the next day" are not reasonable excuses), to have your absence excused.

Each student is allowed to miss **one class** for a valid reason: illness, family emergency, or reasonable excuse; this first absence will not count towards your final grade. Additional absences may be allowed in special cases, but must be discussed with, and approved by Dr. Gabriela Nagy by email, prior to the absence. Unexcused absences may result in a failing grade. **If you have 4 unexcused absences or accumulate 4 "zeros" in the participation section in Brightspace, you will need to retake the class another semester**.

3.4. Conduct and Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is one of the highest values that Purdue University holds. Individuals are encouraged to alert university officials to potential breaches of this value by either emailing integrity@purdue.edu or by calling 765-494-8778. While information may be submitted anonymously, the more information is submitted the greater the opportunity for the university to investigate the concern. More details are available on our course Brightspace table of contents, under University Policies.

I do not expect to have any unprofessional behavior or academic dishonesty issues in this class; however, my expectations and consequences are as follows:

Students are expected to always behave professionally during class. Students will hear from a variety of informed and accomplished speakers who will broaden and improve your educational experience through this series of seminars. We consider it a high priority to treat these speakers with professional courtesy and respect.

Unfortunately, sometimes students choose not to behave professionally. **Unprofessional behavior such as disruptive talking, using laptops or cell phones (unless instructed to do so), reading newspapers, working on another subject, eating, sleeping or getting up and leaving the room for short periods of times for no good reason during the seminar will not be tolerated.** For the first time when this happens, the student will be warned. Additional unprofessional behavior for the same student will result in a class absence for that student.

Any student caught plagiarizing in an assignment will receive 0 (zero) points for that assignment and will be reported to the Director of Undergraduate Studies; this may result in failing the class.

Completing ***iClicker*** polls remotely to get credit for participation while you are not physically in class is considered academic dishonesty and will not be tolerated. Any student identified as completing polls outside of classroom, along with their helper(s) (if any) will receive a failing grade in the course, will be reported to the Director of Undergraduate Studies in our School and will be referred to the Office of Student Rights and Responsibilities (OSRR) for review at university level.

3.5. Grading

Grading is based on the following:

Participation	15%
Assignments (3 graded assignments)	85%
Mentoring Assignment (although not graded, it is required to pass the class)	
Total	**100%**

Final grade (letter grade) assignment is shown in Table 1:

Table 1: Letter grade assignment based on percentage achieved.

A+	100.0 - 97.0%	**B+**	86.5 - 89.5%	**C+**	76.0 - 78.9%	**D+**	65.5 - 68.4%	**F**	< 58.0%
A	96.9 - 93.0%	**B**	82.5 - 86.4%	**C**	72.0 - 75.9%	**D**	61.5 - 65.4%		
A-	92.9 - 89.5%	**B-**	79.0 - 82.4%	**C-**	68.5 - 71.9%	**D-**	58.0 - 61.4%		

There are 3 graded assignments that are part of the CHE 30000 course requirements; these will be given as shown on the lecture schedule. Assignment requirements, including due date, will be provided in Brightspace.

Late assignments are accepted if they are submitted within 24 hours of due date, but there will be a **15% penalty** applied to the grade for that assignment. Assignments submitted after 24 hours after the due date will not be accepted, unless previously approved by Dr. G. Nagy via email.

Revised Grades: Any requests for regrading an assignment must be made in writing, to Dr. Gabriela Nagy (nagyg@purdue.edu) **within 48 hours** from when the scores for that assignment were released on Brightspace. Requests received later than two days will not be accepted.

Mentoring Assignment

For this course, each student is required to meet with their assigned faculty mentor in-person or via an online platform such as WebEx, Zoom, Microsoft Teams, etc., **before April 29, 2026**, and submit the completed mentor meeting sheet via Brightspace, as proof of assignment completion (see the assignment description and form on Brightspace for more information). You were notified by email from the Undergraduate Office with the name of your faculty mentor. If you have not been notified who your mentor is, it is your responsibility to follow-up with the Undergraduate Office (email Ms. Sandy Hendryx at hendryxs@purdue.edu) to determine who your faculty mentor is. Contact information for our faculty members can be found on our School's website; direct link: https://engineering.purdue.edu/ChE/people/ptFaculty.

If you have been unable to meet with your mentor before the last week of classes due to the mentor's schedule, you must submit copies of two emails that include the date, time, and ***to*** and ***from*** headings showing you have made a good effort and that the limitation is due to the mentor, not the student. **One of those documented attempts must be dated before April 1, 2026, and one dated during the week of April 13-17, 2026.** It is not reasonable to make your first attempt to email your faculty mentor near the submission deadline, April 29, 2026. Although it is not graded and does not count towards your final grade, completion of the *Mentoring Assignment* is a condition to complete this course. Students are encouraged to keep trying to schedule a meeting with their mentor before submitting the assignments without meeting with their mentor; **assignments without a mentor meeting, but with proof of contact as described above will ONLY be accepted starting April 22, 2026**. The due date to submit your completed mentor meeting sheet via Brightspace is **Wednesday, April 29, 2026.**

3.5. Nondiscrimination

Purdue University is committed to maintaining a community which recognizes and values the inherent worth and dignity of every person; fosters tolerance, sensitivity, understanding, and mutual respect among its members; and encourages each individual to strive to reach his or her own potential. In pursuit of its goal of academic excellence, the University seeks to develop and nurture diversity. The University believes that diversity among its many members strengthens the institution, stimulates creativity, promotes the exchange of ideas, and enriches campus life. Purdue's nondiscrimination policy can be found at http://www.purdue.edu/purdue/ea_eou_statement.html.

3.6. Students with disabilities

Purdue University strives to make learning experiences as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience physical or academic barriers based on disability, you are welcome to let me know, so that we can discuss options. You are also encouraged to contact the Disability Resource Center at: drc@purdue.edu or by phone: 765-494-1247.

Please also familiarize yourself with the Davidson School of Chemical Engineering specific procedures that need to be followed by students who have a Letter of Accommodation (LOA) from the Disability Resource Center (DRC). The information can be found here: https://engineering.purdue.edu/ChE/academics/undergraduate/ada-information-for-students

3.7. Emergency Procedures

The evacuation and shelter-in-place procedures will be reviewed in class, and students are responsible for understanding and adhering to these procedures in the event of an emergency.

3.8. Major Campus Emergency

In the event of a major campus emergency, course requirements, deadlines and grading are subject to changes that may be necessitated by a revised semester calendar or other circumstances. Information about relevant changes in will be posted on Brightspace and emailed to the enrolled student e-mail list.